

Philips 17-inch W 170T4 Wide-screen Multifunctional LCD monitor

Another entrant in the widescreen LCD-TV segment is the Philips 17-inch W 170T4 monitor. It's better than the Samsung in terms of performance as a monitor, as well as in terms of display quality.

A TV tuner is built into the monitor, taking care of your TV viewing needs. This monitor also supports HDTV, so, as and when HDTV is available in India, you'll be prepared. There's a screen mode that lets you switch between standard mode, 4:3 aspect ratio, HD and non-linear scaling mode. Other features include NICAM stereo and a sleep timer, making this device an excellent replacement for your TV.

There are sound controls for everything, including bass, treble and surround sound mode. The monitor gave pretty good results in our Display-Mate battery of tests.

It does its job well, both as a computer LCD and as a TV/Video display device. The Philips 17-inch W 170T4 Wide-screen Multifunctional LCD monitor is

definitely a good buy, especially if you want your monitor to be future-proof.

- + Good picture quality
- Very few features
- Price:** Rs 49,999

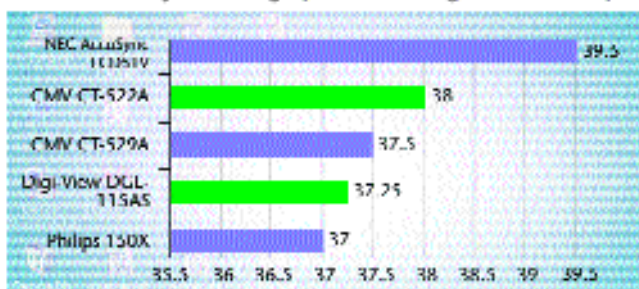


still disappointed us. Based on the results of this test, it is fair to say that this monitor should not be used for working with CAD, CAM or design applications. The BenQ, however, posted good scores, and was second only to the Philips 109P4.

In our sharpness and resolution tests, the BenQ and the Philips 109P4 duelled right to the end. The BenQ lost to the Philips in the resolution matrix and the fine resolution matrix tests. Though the NEC MultiSync 912SB also posted good results in these tests, it could only manage a close third. The aim of these tests is to check the image sharpness with the least distortion possible, and the Phillips 109P4 proved to be the best of the lot.

One of the most important tests is the colour test. A moni-

15" LCD Greyscale Range (Out of 60 - Higher the better)



tor should display colours correctly with little or no bleeding, and should have proper colour controls. Generally, all monitors have the option to set a higher colour temperature—9500 K (Kelvin)—for programs that need it: as mentioned in 'Jargon Buster', lower temperatures are more suitable for viewing images, movies and such, while documents and precise graphic design demand higher temperatures.

The HCL 985RFM was not up to the mark in our colour tests, as colour mixing was prevalent at some places on the screen. Streaking and ghosting were other parts of the tests where the HCL suffered. The Samsung 955DF and the NEC MultiSync 920 and the Samsung 955DF posted the best scores among all the monitors in the colour streaking subtest. Overall, the HCL monitor was disappointing, and we recommend staying away from it.

Our last batch of tests consisted of tests that checked the flicker and screen uniformity, and included the dark screen test. The LG Studioworks 910E posted the best mix of scores here—it did the best in the screen uniformity and flicker tests. The Philips 109E5 disappointed us in the flicker test, where it posted the lowest score of all.

All CRT monitors reflect light, but the amount of reflection should not cause eye strain. Here, all the monitors posted relatively low scores, but the BenQ was the worst of the lot, with high dark screen reflection.

Philips 109E5



With all the features that you'd want, such as FFST and Aperture Grille, the Philips 109E5's low price and good performance made an obvious Best Value winner. This sleek white monitor is ideal for daily use, including Web surfing, watching movies, playing games and using office applications.



The Philips 109E5 posted the third-highest scores in the geometry test, leaving some flat-screen monitors behind. The dot pitch of this monitor is 0.25 mm—pretty much acceptable—but the best part is the high resolution it offers: 1,920 x 1,440 pixels at 60

Hz. This is the same resolution that our performance winner offers, but the Philips 109E5 is a whopping Rs 8,850 cheaper.

With the 109E5, Philips has struck the ideal balance between price, performance and features. It's the best entry-level option we've seen so far. If you want a monitor that'll get your job done in a very decent way, and is also eminently affordable, this one is your best bet.

- + Good video bandwidth, high resolutions, Aperture Grille
- None
- Price:** Rs 11,500